



Notification Waiver Determination

SLR Consulting Australia - Hydrobiology

Acquisition	SLR Consulting Australia Pty Ltd (SLR) applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of: a. 100% of the issued share capital of Hydrobiology Pty Ltd (Hydrobiology AU), b. the 33% of the issued share capital of Hydrobiology WA Pty Ltd not owned by Hydrobiology AU, and c. the 33% of the issued share capital of Hydrobiology Singapore Pte Ltd not owned by Hydrobiology AU, as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	25 June 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, SLR (together with its subsidiaries), supplies environmental consulting services in Australia, including strategic advisory and technical consulting to its clients across the energy, finance, mining, infrastructure, manufacturing, and technology industries. The environmental consulting services SLR supplies include ESG advisory services, environmental risk assessments, impact assessments, engineering, scientific and technical services, ecological, efficient energy and water management services, and town planning and project management services. The target, Hydrobiology AU (together with its subsidiaries, Hydrobiology), supplies integrated environmental consulting services in the physical, biological, and chemical processes of environmental systems, with a particular emphasis on aquatic environments or ecosystems, generally referred to as 'aquatic environments consulting services'. Hydrobiology has offices in Queensland, Western Australia, and Singapore, and has 54 staff in Australia. Its core focuses are environmental risk assessments, impact assessments, and environmental management, for projects affecting aquatic environments or ecosystems consisting of marine, freshwater, and coastal systems. Both SLR and Hydrobiology provide environmental consulting services, including for aquatic environments, in Australia.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered

	the information provided with the notification waiver application, and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: a. there is limited overlap between the types of environmental consulting services offered by the parties, as SLR is a multidisciplinary environmental consulting firm and Hydrobiology specialises in the supply of aquatic environments consulting services b. the parties' combined shares of supply of environmental consulting services and aquatic environments consulting services nationally are estimated to be low c. there are alternative providers of environmental consulting services and aquatic environments consulting services in Australia. In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act